ticket monster ~~master~~

how to win the Ticketmaster wars & defeat Live Nation

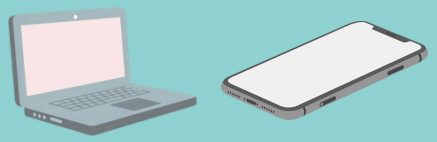
what *you'll learn*

- Ticketmaster's history & how it captured the market
- Step-by-step: how to actually get tickets
- Other ticket platforms & workarounds
- Long-term activism to break up the monopoly

Ella Chee

step-by-step *guide*

1. Keep phone close, use (charged) laptop



2. Ensure secure internet connection (turn off VPN, avoid public WiFi)
3. Have presale code ready

THE123CODE567

4. Enter waiting room ASAP (15-30mins before sale)
5. Use one browser (only one tab per concert date)
6. Once in queue, don't refresh, stay alert for your turn
7. Select # of tickets, choose seats, confirm payment
8. You did it!

alternative *options*

Look for in-person box offices or purchase tickets at venue

Maggie Rogers' 2024 Don't Forget Me tour in-person box office[6]

Use Dice, alternative to TM, new platform with upfront prices

long-term *activism*

- Email or call the D.O.J/F.T.C[4]
- Join class-action suits
- Publicize issues: document and share on social media
- Support artists/venues that use independent ticketing

rise of the *Ticketmaster monopoly*

1976
Ticketmaster (TM) founded, sells ticketing hardware to venues[2]

1985
Switches to computerized ticketing

2000s
Acquires competitors, begins to control promotion/venues/ticketing

2010
TM + Live Nation merges → becomes Live Nation Entertainment (LNE)

- Controls 70% of primary ticketing and live event venues
- Scalps own tickets, owns secondary marketplaces
- Pressures artists and venues
- Imposes hidden fees and extreme service charges (78% of base price)

2022
Taylor Swift Eras tour disaster (fraud, presale crashes, public outrage)

2023
U.S. Senate hearing on LNE monopoly hurting artists/customers[1]
music artist Clyde Lawrence testifies[5]

2024
D.O.J. files antitrust lawsuit against LNE for monopolizing market

2025
Olivia Dean demands cap on resale prices for "The Art of Loving" tour
** only addresses scalpers/bots*

2026
D.O.J. settlement with LNE, with certain conditions[3]
**not a full break-up*

before *ticket sale*

- ☐ Join artist mailing list/social media to find tour dates
- ☐ When tour announced, set reminder on event page, allow text reminders
- ☐ Sign up for presale events (save presale codes)

venue *artist* *credit card*

- ☐ Have credit card and address saved to Ticketmaster
- ☐ Know number of tickets and max price willing to spend
- ☐ Check ticket limits beforehand
- ☐ Have as many people in your group join the sale

citations

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